

Gmail, Google Drive, Photos and more and as of now, you get 15GB free storage with every Google account. Combine the ever increasing storage and the self-sustaining model of an inbox with ads, and Google has quite possibly cracked email for good.

Even though Google's attachments are currently limited to 50MB, the ability to attach files directly from Google Drive has practically removed file size restrictions from Gmail, giving users another reason to chose it over other services. Another thing that Gmail brought about that eventually spread to other email services was the threaded email conversations view. As opposed to displaying each and every message chronologically in your inbox, this view made the entire email experience a lot less cluttered. All in all, Gmail has probably changed the world of email forever and it will continue doing so almost single handedly.

Which brings us to one such attempt – Inbox. Inbox (a separate app by Google) is essentially a new email client for your Gmail account – one that goes beyond assisting you with sending and receiving emails. The USP of Inbox lies in what it can do with the content of those emails. Labelled bundles group emails of the same topic together, highlights show key details from messages, and reminders, assists, and snooze functionality enable users to control when specific information appears. Further updates to Inbox have also enabled an undo send feature, a “Smart Reply” feature that automatically generates short reply examples for certain emails, integration with Google Calendar for event organization, previews of newsletters, and a “Save to Inbox” feature that lets users save links for later use. While all of these features pretty much work as advertised, concerns over email privacy combined with occasional reports of the features malfunctioning have proved to be roadblocks for Inbox to gain mass popularity.

## Google Assistant

While Siri is credited as the harbinger of virtual assistants, and Cortana is often considered the second most iconic AI-based assistant, it is the Google Assistant (the spiritual successor to Google Now) that has repeatedly won most comparison tests when it comes to accuracy and functionality. But to truly understand it's significance, one has to look at Google Now, its spiritual predecessor in Google's assisting efforts.

Unveiled in 2012, Google Now's USP was using your information from across the Google ecosystem and providing you contextual cards that served as your gateway to various services - essentially leveraging Google's